

Deployment & CI / CD

How CI tests + builds images on every push, how CD auto-deploys from a green main, the required secrets, and the manual / rollback operations.

End-to-end guide: from a blank VDS to a live, self-deploying production stack. Once it's set up, every `git push origin main` ends with the new version rolling on the server about fifteen minutes later — no manual SSH.

What this covers

1. The end-to-end flow at a glance
2. The accounts you need (provider list + price ceiling)
3. **First-time VDS setup** — the one-hour, one-time walkthrough
4. The **CI** pipeline that runs on every push
5. The **CD** pipeline that auto-deploys from a green `main`
6. Choosing the mail FROM address
7. Required GitHub repo secrets
8. Manual operations + rollback
9. Failure handling

End-to-end flow

```

git push origin main
    |
    v
+-----+
|   GitHub CI   | ci.yml - ~12-15 min
| test · lint · | build + push images to GHCR
| sonar · build |
+-----+
|   CI green    |
    v
+-----+
|   GitHub CD   | deploy.yml - ~2-3 min
| SSH → VDS     | git pull · compose pull · up -d
+-----+
    |
    v
VDS rolling forward
(pre-built GHCR images)

```

End-to-end: ~17 minutes from `git push` to the new version live. After the initial setup, no manual SSH is ever needed.

Prerequisites — accounts to create

SERVICE	WHAT FOR	RECOMMENDED	COST
Domain + DNS + TLS	one place for everything	Cloudflare (registrar + DNS + free proxy TLS)	~\$10/year
VDS (compute)	running the stack	Contabo Cloud VPS (16 GB+ x86, EU) or Hetzner	~\$9–25/month
Mail relay (SMTP)	outbound mail (verify, 2FA, alerts)	Brevo (300/day free ≈ 9k/month) or Resend	\$0 for low volume
GitHub	code + CI + image registry	GitHub (GHCR comes with the repo)	\$0

Total typical cost: ~\$10/year + \$9–25/month.

First-time VDS setup

A one-time, ~1-hour walkthrough done from scratch on a fresh server. After this the CD pipeline handles everything.

1. Provision the VDS

- **Spec:** ≥16 GB RAM (the stack runs OpenSearch + Kafka + Keycloak + two JVMs + Postgres), x86/amd64, Ubuntu 24.04 LTS. ~100 GB NVMe is plenty for code + Postgres + indices + image cache. EU region for low latency from TR.
- Order from your chosen provider (Contabo Cloud VPS 20 NVMe and similar tiers fit the bill).
- During order, paste your laptop's SSH public key (next step) into the provider's "SSH public key" field — most providers offer this and skip generating a root password.

2. SSH access from your laptop

Generate a key once on your machine (no passphrase — required for unattended deploys):

```
ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -C "your-comment" -f ~/.ssh/id_ed25519 -N ""
cat ~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub           # paste this into the provider
```

After the VDS is provisioned, verify the key login works:

```
ssh root@<VDS_IP> 'uname -a'
```

If the provider auto-generated a password instead of accepting the key, install it once with that password:

```
ssh-copy-id -i ~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub root@<VDS_IP>
```

3. Initial hardening — disable password authentication

Once key login works, drop the password door entirely. Bots constantly brute-force SSH on the open internet — turning passwords off closes that attack surface.

On the server, in `/etc/ssh/sshd_config`, set `PasswordAuthentication no`. Ubuntu cloud images usually re-enable it inside `/etc/ssh/sshd_config.d/50-cloud-init.conf` — change it there too. Then `systemctl reload sshd`. Verify with `sshd -T | grep -i passwordauth`.

Your key login keeps working; anything else is rejected. **Don't lose the private key on your laptop** — back it up to a password manager or Time Machine.

4. Install Docker + Compose plugin

The official one-shot script (Ubuntu / Debian / RHEL):

```
ssh root@<VDS_IP> 'curl -fsSL https://get.docker.com | sh'
ssh root@<VDS_IP> 'docker --version && docker compose version'
```

5. Clone the repo on the VDS

The repo is public, so a plain HTTPS clone works — no deploy key or token needed:

```
ssh root@<VDS_IP>
cd /root
git clone https://github.com/<owner>/<repo>.git
cd <repo>
```

If you later make the repo private, swap the HTTPS URL for SSH (`git@github.com:<owner>/<repo>.git`) and add a read-only **Deploy Key** (Settings → Deploy keys) so the VDS can pull without a user account.

6. Cloudflare DNS + free HTTPS

Cloudflare gives DNS + TLS termination for free if your domain is on its DNS.

In the Cloudflare dashboard → `<your-domain>` → **DNS** → **Records** → **Add record**:

TYPE	NAME	VALUE	PROXY
A	@	<VDS_IP>	Proxied (orange cloud)
A	www	<VDS_IP>	Proxied

The orange-cloud proxy gives you free HTTPS at the edge (no Let's Encrypt to manage), DDoS protection, and a CDN. Your VDS keeps serving plain HTTP on port 80; Cloudflare terminates TLS.

7. Mail relay — Brevo example

Brevo's free tier (300/day ≈ 9,000/month) is plenty for transactional mail (account verify, 2FA, alerts). Same flow for Resend / SES with minor differences.

1. Sign up at `app.brevo.com` (no card needed for free).
2. **Senders & Domains** → **Add domain** → enter `your-domain.com`.
3. Brevo gives you 2-3 DNS records to verify (DKIM CNAMEs). If your DNS is on Cloudflare, Brevo can install them automatically with one click ("Authorize") — much easier than pasting them by hand.
4. Wait for verification to flip green (1-10 minutes).
5. **Settings** → **SMTP & API** → **Generate a new SMTP key**. Copy the long key once — Brevo won't show it again.

You'll plug `smtp-relay.brevo.com:587` + your Brevo SMTP login + that key into the `.env` in the next step.

8. Production `.env`

The repo ships a `.env.example` with every variable documented. Copy and fill in:

```
cd /root/<repo>
cp .env.example .env
chmod 600 .env
nano .env
```

Replace the placeholders with strong random values from your password manager (or `pwgen`).

OpenSearch needs 8+ characters with upper, lower, digit, and a special character — respect that or the container won't start.

Critical sections:

- **Login:** `FINANCE_ADMIN_PASSWORD`, `DEMO_USER_PASSWORD` — the demo-visible accounts (keep simple if it's a showcase; randomise for a real install).
- **Infra:** `KEYCLOAK_ADMIN_PASSWORD`, `DB_PASSWORD`, `REDIS_PASSWORD`, `LDAP_ADMIN_PASSWORD`, `LDAP_CONFIG_PASSWORD`, `OPENSEARCH_PASSWORD` (OpenSearch needs `≥ 8` chars with upper + lower + digit + special — the inline command above produces a compliant one).
- **Mail:** `SPRING_MAIL_HOST=smtp-relay.brevo.com`, `SPRING_MAIL_PORT=587`, `SPRING_MAIL_USERNAME=<brevo SMTP login>`, `SPRING_MAIL_PASSWORD=<brevo SMTP key>`, `SPRING_MAIL_PROPERTIES_MAIL_SMTP_AUTH=true`, `SPRING_MAIL_PROPERTIES_MAIL_SMTP_STARTTLS_ENABLE=true`, `NOTIFICATION_FROM_ADDRESS=noreply@your-domain.com`
- **Domain / frontend:** `FRONTEND_BASE_URL=https://your-domain.com`, `VITE_KEYCLOAK_URL=https://your-domain.com/auth`. These are baked into the frontend at build

time — set them before the first build.

Demo / showcase tip: with `make demo` or the `docker-compose.demo.yml` overlay you get a seeded portfolio and a `demouser` account; in that mode you don't need any market-data API keys (`EVDS_API_KEY` / `COINGECKO_KEY` can be empty). Set `APP_MARKET_INIT_ENABLED=false` so the backend doesn't try a cold-start fetch.

9. First deploy

The first deploy builds the images on the server (CI hasn't pushed any yet). Use the demo overlay if you want seeded data; layer the prod overlay on top to skip the Mailpit dev catcher and send mail through Brevo:

```
docker compose -f docker-compose.yml -f docker-compose.demo.yml -f docker-compose.prod.yml up -d --build
```

First build is ~25–35 minutes (Maven downloads + JVM compile + Vite + Docker layers + db-seed loading the 46 MB market snapshot). Watch it with `docker compose logs -f`.

10. Verify it's up

```
docker compose ps                # everything Up + healthy
curl -fsS https://your-domain.com/actuator/health  # should be 200
curl -fsS https://your-domain.com/                # frontend HTML
```

Open `https://your-domain.com` in a browser. Login with the admin credentials from `.env`. Trigger a real action (price alert / 2FA / account verify) and watch the email show up at your real inbox (it goes out through Brevo with proper DKIM, not Mailpit).

That's the one-time setup done. From here on, every `git push origin main` deploys automatically.

CI pipeline (`.github/workflows/ci.yml`)

Triggered on every pull request and every push to `main`.

JOB	WHAT IT DOES	DEPENDS ON
<code>finance-common-test</code>	builds + tests the shared library, uploads JaCoCo XML	—
<code>backend-test</code>	installs finance-common, runs the backend Maven reactor (<code>./mvnw verify</code>), uploads per-module JaCoCo XML	<code>finance-common-test</code>
<code>notification-test</code>	builds + tests the notification microservice, uploads JaCoCo XML	<code>finance-common-test</code>
<code>frontend-lint</code>	<code>npm ci && npm run lint</code>	—

JOB	WHAT IT DOES	DEPENDS ON
sonar	SonarQube scan, downloads JaCoCo artifacts (gated on <code>vars.SONAR_HOST_URL</code>)	all the above
docker-backend	builds + pushes the backend image to GHCR	backend-test, finance-common-test
docker-notification-backend	same for notification	notification-test, finance-common-test
docker-frontend	same for frontend (with <code>VITE_*</code> build args from repo variables)	frontend-lint
compose-validate	sanity-checks the merged compose resolves cleanly	all docker-*

Tests + lint run on **every PR**. Image builds and the push to GHCR only run on **push to main**, so PRs never pollute the registry. JaCoCo XML is uploaded as a workflow artifact so the Sonar job can read it across modules.

CD pipeline (`.github/workflows/deploy.yml`)

Triggered automatically when CI succeeds on `main`, or manually via the Actions UI:

```
on:
  workflow_dispatch:
  workflow_run:
    workflows: ["CI"]
    types: [completed]
    branches: [main]

jobs:
  deploy:
    if: github.event_name == 'workflow_dispatch'
    || github.event.workflow_run.conclusion == 'success'
```

Steps (over SSH to the VDS):

1. `git pull --ff-only` — compose files + mounted config (small, seconds)
2. `docker compose pull` — fetches the new images from GHCR (public, no login needed)
3. `docker compose -f docker-compose.yml -f docker-compose.prod.yml up -d` — rolling restart of only the services whose image hash changed
4. `docker image prune -f` — cleans up the old image versions

No source compile on the server, no Maven, no npm. Pull + restart only. ~2-3 minutes end-to-end.

Mail — choosing the FROM address

The mail provider (Brevo / Resend / SES) is the SMTP relay; it isn't a mailbox. You don't need to "create an account" for `noreply@your-domain.com` — once the domain is verified in the provider, you can send from **any address on that domain** and the provider signs it with DKIM so receivers accept it as legitimate.

Common conventions:

ADDRESS	USE
<code>noreply@your-domain.com</code>	Signals "don't reply, this is automated". Most common.
<code>hi@your-domain.com</code>	Friendlier, e.g. for product newsletters.
<code>admin@your-domain.com</code>	System / ops alerts.

Set the chosen address in `NOTIFICATION_FROM_ADDRESS` in `.env`. To **receive** replies you need actual email hosting (Google Workspace, Zoho, Fastmail ...) — that's a separate concern from sending and isn't required for the app to work.

Image registry

CI builds three custom images and pushes them to **GitHub Container Registry (GHCR)**, tagged with both `latest` and the short commit SHA:

```
ghcr.io/<owner>/finance-portal-backend
ghcr.io/<owner>/finance-portal-notification-backend
ghcr.io/<owner>/finance-portal-frontend
```

The packages are public on GHCR (the repo is public), so the VDS pulls without any registry login. All third-party images (Postgres, Kafka, Keycloak, OpenSearch, Redis, Nginx, ...) come from their public official registries unchanged.

Required GitHub repo secrets

Under **Settings** → **Secrets and variables** → **Actions**:

SECRET	PURPOSE
<code>VDS_HOST</code>	Server IP or hostname
<code>VDS_USER</code>	SSH user on the server
<code>VDS_SSH_KEY</code>	Private key matching the server's <code>~/.ssh/authorized_keys</code>
<code>VDS_APP_DIR</code>	Absolute path of the cloned repo on the server (e.g. <code>/root/<repo></code>)

The GHCR images are public, so the deploy workflow pulls them without any registry token. No PAT is needed.

Optional, only with self-hosted Sonar:

- `SONAR_TOKEN` (secret) and `SONAR_HOST_URL` (variable)

Manual operations

Force a deploy from any commit without touching code:

```
gh workflow run deploy.yml
```

Or: Actions → *Deploy to VDS* → **Run workflow**.

Pin a specific image version (rollback to a known-good SHA): on the server, set

```
BACKEND_IMAGE=ghcr.io/.../finance-portal-backend:<sha> in .env and run docker compose -f docker-compose.yml -f docker-compose.prod.yml up -d backend
```

The compose file reads `${BACKEND_IMAGE:-...}`, so any tag can be pinned through env without editing source.

Check what's running:

```
ssh root@vds 'cd app && docker compose ps'
ssh root@vds 'cd app && docker compose logs -f --tail=200 backend'
```

Stop the stack temporarily (to save VDS cost):

```
ssh root@vds 'cd app && docker compose down' # keeps data
```

Failure handling

- A failing test, lint, or Sonar quality gate **fails CI** and stops the pipeline — no image is pushed, no deploy fires. The running version on the VDS is untouched.
- A failing image build (`docker-*`) likewise blocks deploy. CI must be green for `deploy.yml` to fire.
- If `deploy.yml` itself fails (SSH timeout, registry login error, compose error), the previous version keeps running on the VDS — `docker compose pull` only pulls; the running container is replaced only when `up -d` succeeds.
- A container failing to start after `up -d` is visible in `docker compose ps` and the container's logs (`docker compose logs <service>`). Roll back to the previous SHA with the image-tag override above.

Why this shape

- CI tests + image build are split into separate jobs so the slow ones (Maven reactor, Docker buildx) run in parallel with the fast ones (lint, finance-common). Failures surface faster.
- CD is a separate workflow (`workflow_run`) instead of one more job in CI, so deploys honour CI's exact pass/fail and never race the image push.
- Images are pre-built in CI rather than on the server: the VDS doesn't need Maven, npm, build tools or large heap — only Docker. Deploys are fast, the server stays small, and every environment runs the exact same image bytes that CI tested.
- Cloudflare in front of the VDS gives free HTTPS, free DDoS protection, and a CDN cache for the static frontend — without any TLS certificate to manage on the server.
- One single SMTP block in `.env` drives **both** the app's transactional mail and Keycloak's account emails (verify / 2FA / reset), so switching mail provider is one config block to update, not two.

Local vs VDS — what's actually different

Same compose, same code, same images. Only a few `.env` keys change:

KEY	LOCAL DEFAULT	VDS VALUE
<code>FRONTEND_BASE_URL</code>	<code>http://localhost</code>	<code>https://your-domain.com</code>
<code>VITE_API_BASE_URL</code>	<code>/api/v1</code> (same-origin)	<code>/api/v1</code> (same-origin, unchanged)
<code>VITE_KEYCLOAK_URL</code>	<code>http://localhost/auth</code>	<code>https://your-domain.com/auth</code>
<code>SPRING_MAIL_HOST</code>	<code>mailpit</code> (catcher)	<code>smtp-relay.brevo.com</code>
<code>SPRING_MAIL_PORT</code>	<code>1025</code>	<code>587</code>
<code>SPRING_MAIL_USERNAME</code>	(blank)	your Brevo SMTP login
<code>SPRING_MAIL_PASSWORD</code>	(blank)	your Brevo SMTP key
<code>SPRING_MAIL_PROPERTIES_MAIL_SMTP_AUTH</code>	<code>false</code>	<code>true</code>
<code>SPRING_MAIL_PROPERTIES_MAIL_SMTP_STARTTLS_ENABLE</code>	<code>false</code>	<code>true</code>
<code>NOTIFICATION_FROM_ADDRESS</code>	<code>noreply@finance.local</code>	<code>noreply@your-domain.com</code>
<code>ORIGIN_CERT_CN</code>	unset (defaults <code>localhost</code>)	<code>your-domain.com</code>

KEY	LOCAL DEFAULT	VDS VALUE
<code>APP_MARKET_INIT_ENABLED</code>	<code>true</code>	<code>false</code> (demo seed is loaded instead)

The compose overlay also changes: `docker-compose.yml` + `docker-compose.prod.yml` on VDS (drops the Mailpit dev catcher); `docker-compose.yml` + `docker-compose.demo.yml` locally (adds the demo seed and `demouser`).

Choosing demo vs empty database

Two ways to bring the stack up — same code, different startup seed:

- **Demo** (`make demo`) — `docker-compose.demo.yml` adds the `db-seed` one-shot container that loads `seed/market_data.sql.gz` (~4 years of candles) plus `seed/demo_portfolio.sql` (the sample portfolio), and the `realm-demo.json` realm provisions `demouser` / `Demo123!` who owns that portfolio. Best for clone-and-run showcase. No EVDS/CoinGecko key needed.
- **Empty** (`make empty`) — boots with empty tables. The backend's `MarketDataInitializer` detects empty tables and pulls multi-year history from the upstreams (FX → stocks → commodities) on first run; this takes ~20–30 min and **requires** `EVDS_API_KEY` because stocks and commodities are converted through FX. Set `APP_MARKET_INIT_ENABLED=false` to skip the cold-start fetch entirely.

`make reset` wipes all volumes if you want to switch modes; `make down` just stops without losing data.